02 / RVU PRACTICAL RESOURCES

TARGET RESEARCH FIELDNOTES

02

Target research fieldnotes

Understand the application before adding tools.

Build a small map, prioritized questions and evidence for each test before expanding your toolchain.

01

Set boundaries

Assets, accounts and engagement rules

02

Map the app

Features, requests, roles and resources

03

Prioritize

A clear hypothesis and a verifiable outcome

ENGLISH EDITION

GUIDE + WORKSHEET / 04 PAGES

02 / METHOD / REFERENCE

Five steps to a clearer target

A small map, prioritized questions and evidence for each test

01 Boundaries

- [ ] Record allowed assets, exclusions, account rules and request limits.
- [ ] Verify newly discovered assets are in scope before interacting.
- [ ] Identify your test accounts and available roles.

02 Normal behavior

- [ ] Use core features: create, read, update and cancel.
- [ ] Follow requests and responses in Burp Suite.
- [ ] Identify session storage and changes during login and logout.
- [ ] Map workflow steps and allowed state transitions.

03 Application map

Create columns for: feature, path, method, role, resource, potential impact and notes.

- [ ] Map relevant paths from application traffic, JavaScript and available documentation.
- [ ] Link identifiers to resources and owners.
- [ ] Identify sensitive features such as recovery, email changes, roles and payments.
- [ ] Record uncertainties instead of assuming answers.

02 / REVIEW / NEXT STEPS

From a map to a testable hypothesis

A small map, prioritized questions and evidence for each test

04 Testable hypotheses

- [ ] Are roles and resource ownership checked at each step?
- [ ] Does the server validate prices, quantities and state?
- [ ] Do the UI and corresponding API enforce the same rules?
- [ ] Can a state transition happen before its prerequisites?
- [ ] Give each test a baseline, one controlled change, expected outcome and evidence requirement.

05 Prioritize and review

- [ ] Start with sensitive features you can verify using appropriate test accounts and resources.
- [ ] Record negative results too.
- [ ] Distinguish server-side impact from local interface changes.
- [ ] Leave yourself a clear next step before stopping.

Measure progress by whether you can explain what you are testing, why it matters and which evidence would confirm the result.

02 / PRACTICE / WORKSHEET

Your target research worksheet

A small map, prioritized questions and evidence for each test

Asset and boundaries

Accounts and roles

A small application map

Feature / endpoint	Role / resource	Question / observation

One hypothesis to start with

Expected rule + the assumption to test

Baseline and controlled change

Expected outcome and evidence

Notes and next step

What is confirmed and what still needs evidence?

Before adding tools

Can you explain what you will test, why it matters and which result would support or reject the hypothesis? If not, return to the map.